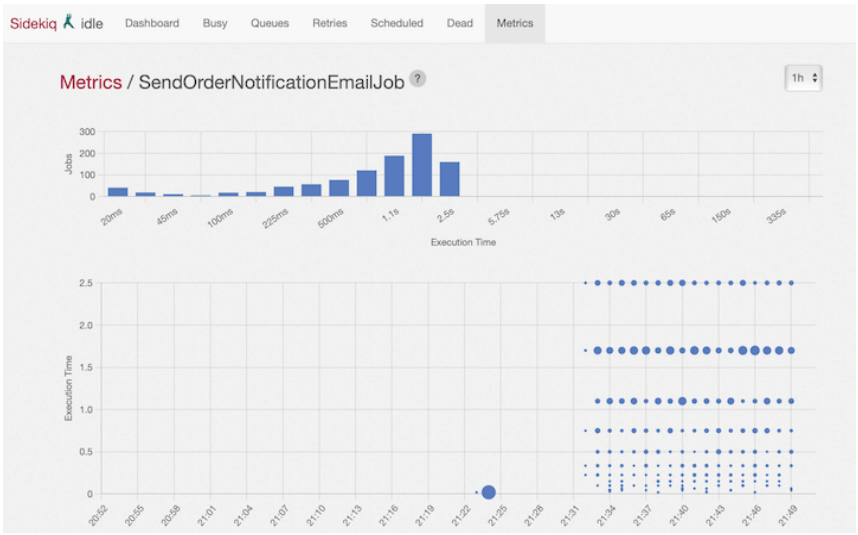


A screenshot of the Sidekiq Web UI that shows a bar graph showing a distribution of jobs by execution time, with most jobs taking 1.5 seconds, but a wide array of timings. There is also a two-dimensional dot graph. The X-axis is a timestamp and the Y-axis is an execution time. The size of the dot represents the number of jobs that executed in that time. The distribution is somewhat uniform because of the use of `rand`.

In a real-world app, this tab can be invaluable to give you an overview of how your Sidekiq installation is behaving. What it can't do is provide any sort of automated alerting. While a commercial monitoring tool *can* do that, it's worth understanding what you can do on your own, with just the API provided by Sidekiq.

Sidekiq's Internal API Provides Scriptable Observability

Sidekiq has an internal—but documented and supported—API you can use to provide basic monitoring and alerting without having a third-party monitoring system in place. Even if you have one, basic self-contained alerting can give you some piece of mind that you will know if anything is going wrong.

The approach to using Sidekiq's API for alerting and monitoring is to create code that checks what you want, then notifies you if something is wrong. Let's create a Rake task that checks if Sidekiq is running by using `Sidekiq::ProcessSet`.